of the massiveness of macrosystems allowing one to neglect further quantum effects… but never give any justification for this flatly asserted dogma," wrote Everett. "It most certainly does *not* follow from [the Schrödinger equation] which leads to quite strange superposition states [like Schrödinger's cat] even for macrosystems when applied to any measuring processes!" Everett also pointed out that applying the Heisenberg uncertainty principle to measurement devices, as Petersen had done in his reply—and as Bohr had done in his replies to Einstein thirty years earlier—violated the Copenhagen interpretation's strict interdiction against using quantum physics to describe measurements. Yet Petersen and the rest of the Copenhagen camp did not address this point and continued to ignore the criticisms of the Copenhagen interpretation that Everett had laid out in his thesis.

And aside from Bohr's circle in Copenhagen, few people saw Everett's work. Wheeler sent Everett's thesis to a handful of other physicists, such as Schrödinger, Oppenheimer, and Wigner. Many did not even bother to write back. Some who did write back did so simply to argue against it, as Bohr, Petersen, and Stern had. Wheeler tentatively promoted the universal wave function at a 1957 quantum gravity conference in Chapel Hill, but the concept met with a similar fate there. Richard Feynman, who was at the conference (and who had once been a student of Wheeler's himself), simply found Everett's ideas too preposterous to accept. "The concept of a 'universal wave function' has serious difficulties," he told the assembled conference, because it forces you "to believe in the equal reality of an infinity of possible worlds"—a bridge too far, even for a rebel like Feynman.

Not everyone dismissed Everett's new interpretation out of hand. Norbert Weiner, the father of cybernetics and a giant in game theory, was on Wheeler's short mailing list for the thesis; he told Wheeler and Everett that he was "sympathetic to [their] point of view." Wheeler also sent Everett's thesis to Henry Margenau, at Yale, a notable dissenter from the Copenhagen orthodoxy who had been complaining about the measurement problem for years, calling wave function collapse "a mathematical fiction" and a "grotesque claim," and protesting that "measurement should not… be given sacramental unction and expected to perform a redemptive act." Unsurprisingly, he approved of Everett's ideas, though he admitted that he